

# Media & News

45 words · Media & News

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## NOUNS

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### headline

the title of a newspaper article, printed in large letters

*The headline read: "Prime Minister Resigns After Scandal."*

### report

a factual account of an event or investigation published or broadcast

*The report revealed widespread corruption in the industry.*

### source

a person, book, or document that provides information

*The journalist refused to reveal her source.*

### coverage

the way an event or topic is reported in the media

*The media coverage of the trial was excessive.*

### tabloid

a newspaper that focuses on sensational stories and celebrity gossip

*The tabloids ran the story on their front pages for a week.*

### propaganda

information used to promote a particular political viewpoint, often misleadingly

*The documentary explored how propaganda was used during the war.*

### disinformation

deliberately false information spread to deceive the public

*Foreign agents used disinformation campaigns to influence the election.*

### article

a piece of writing about a topic in a newspaper, magazine, or online

*She read an interesting article about sleep science.*

### press

newspapers and journalists considered collectively

*The press has been highly critical of the government's response.*

### broadcast

a programme transmitted by television or radio

*The emergency broadcast warned people to stay indoors.*

### censorship

the suppression of information considered harmful or sensitive

*Censorship of the press is a serious threat to democracy.*

### paywall

an online system that blocks access to content until the reader pays or subscribes

*I couldn't finish the article because it disappeared behind a paywall halfway through.*

### editorial

a newspaper article expressing the editor's opinion on a current issue

*The editorial called for immediate reform of the justice system.*

### whistleblower

a person who exposes wrongdoing within an organisation

*The whistleblower leaked documents showing the company had lied about safety.*

## ADJECTIVES

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### **viral**

(of content) spread rapidly and widely online  
*The clip went viral within hours of being posted.*

### **biased**

unfairly favouring one side over another  
*The coverage was clearly biased towards the ruling party.*

### **sensationalist**

presenting information in a way designed to shock or excite  
*The reporting was sensationalist and lacked any real evidence.*

### **impartial**

treating all sides equally and without bias  
*A good journalist should remain impartial, regardless of personal views.*

### **breaking**

(of news) newly happening and being reported for the first time  
*We interrupt this programme to bring you breaking news.*

### **credible**

able to be believed or trusted as accurate  
*Only information from credible sources should be shared.*

### **misleading**

giving a false or inaccurate impression  
*The headline was deliberately misleading.*

## VERBS

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### **fact-check**

to verify the accuracy of claims before publishing  
*Every claim in the article was thoroughly fact-checked.*

### **allege**

to state that something is true, or that someone has done wrong, without yet providing proof  
*The report alleges that the company knew about the fault for years and said nothing.*

### **spin**

to present information in a way that favours a particular interpretation  
*The party tried to spin the results as a victory despite losing seats.*

## PHRASAL VERBS

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### **keep up with**

to stay informed about current events or developments  
*I try to keep up with the news but it's overwhelming.*

### **blow out of proportion**

to exaggerate the importance or seriousness of something  
*The whole thing was blown completely out of proportion by the media.*

### **play down**

to make something seem less important or serious than it is  
*The government tried to play down the severity of the crisis.*

## COLLOCATIONS

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### a news outlet

an organisation, such as a newspaper, channel or website, that reports news to the public

*The story was picked up by several major news outlets within hours.*

### freedom of the press

the right of journalists to report without government interference

*Freedom of the press is a cornerstone of any democracy.*

### fake news

false or misleading information presented as genuine reporting

*Social media has made it harder to distinguish fake news from real news.*

## IDIOMS

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### spread like wildfire

to become known very quickly by many people

*The rumour spread like wildfire across social media.*

### no smoke without fire

if something is being said, there is probably some truth to it

*I'm not sure I believe all of it, but there's no smoke without fire.*

### a mouthpiece

a person or publication that speaks on behalf of another, often uncritically

*The newspaper is widely seen as a mouthpiece for the government.*

### bring something to light

to make hidden or secret information known to the public

*It was two local reporters who first brought the scandal to light.*

### take with a pinch of salt

to not fully believe something because it may be exaggerated

*Anything you read in the tabloids should be taken with a pinch of salt.*

### bury your head in the sand

to ignore a problem or unpleasant reality by refusing to think about it

*He's been burying his head in the sand lately, saying it's all too depressing to watch.*

### a hatchet job

a piece of writing or reporting that is unfairly harsh, written to damage someone's reputation

*The magazine ran a hatchet job on the actor, cherry-picking quotes to make him sound arrogant.*

### shed light on

to help someone understand something by explaining it or giving them new information

*The new report sheds light on why the project was delayed.*

## SET PHRASES

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### as far as I know

used to say what you believe to be true while admitting you might not have the full picture

*As far as I know, they still haven't confirmed the story officially.*

### off the record

said privately, on the understanding that it won't be published or attributed to you

*He told me off the record that the deal had already fallen through.*

### from what I've heard

used to introduce information you picked up casually rather than confirmed yourself

*From what I've heard, the factory's closing down early next year.*

### go on record

to state something officially and allow yourself to be named as the source

*She wouldn't go on record, so the paper had to call her 'a source close to the family.'*

## MODERN SLANG

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### **clickbait**

online content with a misleading headline  
designed to attract clicks

*The article was pure clickbait. The headline had  
nothing to do with the story.*

### **scoop**

an exclusive news story that one outlet publishes  
before any of its rivals

*The local paper got the scoop on the closure a full  
week before anyone else picked it up.*

### **news junkie**

someone who follows current events constantly,  
checking for updates throughout the day

*He's a total news junkie who scrolls through three  
different apps first thing every morning.*